

KEVIN AU YOUNG

Senior Technical Game Designer

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Senior Game Designer and Technical Designer with 15+ years and 6 shipped titles across 3 studios, spanning AAA console, PC, and VR. I specialize in narrative and mission systems design, with hands-on experience taking levels from blockout to final and building modular pipelines that let teams implement and iterate at scale. Shipped titles including Star Wars: The Force Unleashed and Mafia III, reaching over 15 million players — and most recently cut team iteration time by more than half on an unannounced title with major IP. Looking for roles where systems design and hands-on implementation shape how players experience story-driven content.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS & AWARDS

- **Asgard's Wrath 2** — 10/10 IGN, Immersive Reality Game of the Year (DICE Awards 2024), XR Game of the Year (AIXR)
- **Mafia III** — New York Game Awards: Best Writing; NAVGTR: Outstanding Song Collection; multiple Game Awards nominations
- **Star Wars: The Force Unleashed** — Writers Guild of America Award for Achievement in Video Game Writing

SYSTEMS & TECHNICAL DESIGN

Technical Design · Gameplay Scripting · Narrative & Gameplay Systems Design · Mission Design · Systemic Design · Gameplay Sequencing · Player Experience Flow & Pacing · Modular Content Frameworks · Cross-Discipline Collaboration · Prototyping & Iterative Workflows · Emergent Gameplay · Playtest Iteration · Content Pipelines · Designer Mentorship

TOOLS & TECHNICAL FOUNDATION

Unreal Engine (UE4 / UE5) including Sequencer and World Partition · Blueprint Visual Scripting · Maya & 3D Studio Max (3D Modeling) · Data-Driven Design · Unity · C++ · C#

EXPERIENCE

Sanzaru, AR/VR @ Meta — San Mateo, CA

Senior Designer IC6 | Aug 2024 - Present

Unreleased: Unannounced title working with major IP

- Designed and led adoption of a modular narrative gameplay system — built around content chunking, progression, and pacing — that was adopted by the team, cutting iteration time by more than half and reducing build instability.
- Partnered with engineering from early pre-production to co-develop narrative system architecture, implementation tooling, and data-driven debugging workflows that reduced implementation brittleness and established scalable pipelines for the full design team.
- Pitched, prototyped in Figma and UE5, and drove implementation of core content systems across design and engineering — taking early pre-production problems from whiteboard to shippable tools.
- Worked directly with level and narrative designers to integrate content into narrative systems, defining gameplay states, and refining sequencing logic to improve player flow and reduce implementation errors.
- Mentored 2–3 designers and narrative partners on system workflows and tooling, helping maintain consistency and raising the team's technical proficiency with narrative implementation workflows.

Sanzaru, AR/VR @ Meta — San Mateo, CA

Senior Designer IC5 | Aug 2018 - Aug 2024

Shipped: Asgard's Wrath 2, Asgard's Wrath, Spyro Reignited

- Delivered 60+ hours of main and side story implementation on Asgard's Wrath 2 — integrating gameplay systems, resolving cross-team technical issues, and ensuring content shipped at quality.
- Owned two levels end-to-end on Asgard's Wrath 1 & 2 in UE4, from blockout through narrative scripting, dialogue integration, and final gameplay pacing.
- Pitched and contributed to core game systems including the creature hunting system and codex, helping shape player-facing features beyond assigned content responsibilities.
- Recreated the Sparx levels from the original Spyro games for the rerelease in collaboration with engineering, balancing fidelity to the source material with technical constraints of the new platform.

Hangar 13 — Novato, CA

Senior Mission Designer | Jun 2013 - Jul 2017

Shipped: Mafia 3 and DLC

- Designed and implemented 3 areas from blockout to final on Mafia 3 and Stones Unturned DLC using Illusion Engine, owning full mission lifecycle from concept through gameplay scripting, narrative pacing, and replayability.
- Scripted mission gameplay, gameplay logic, narrative moments, and story pacing while debugging mission flow and implementation issues throughout production.
- Prototyped NPC stealth-follow gameplay mechanics to evaluate player engagement and guidance; findings informed the decision to cut the mechanic before full production investment.
- Worked with world design to place open world activities and adapt the environment around main missions, ensuring content felt grounded in the world rather than layered on top of it.

Kabam — San Francisco, CA

Designer | Jan 2012 - May 2013

- Developed a level editor in Maya using MEL and Python to quickly generate content for an online strategy game
- Built gameplay prototypes and UI layouts in Unity with C# for an early action RPG project, contributing to gameplay iteration and implementation workflows.

Fearless Studios — San Francisco, CA

Designer | Jan 2011 - Dec 2011

- Collaborated on the conception and pitch of an unreleased FPS, contributing across UI, character setup, and gameplay prototyping
- Built game prototypes in Unreal Engine 3 using UnrealScript and C++

LucasArts — San Francisco, CA

Level Designer | Jan 2007 - Nov 2010

Shipped: Star Wars: The Force Unleashed, Star Wars: The Force Unleashed DLC, Star Wars: The Force Unleashed 2

- Designed and shipped 2–3 areas from blockout to final across Star Wars: The Force Unleashed and TFU2, with additional mission development on DLC — contributing to a title that won the Writers Guild Award for Video Game Writing.
- Implemented gameplay scripting including targeted Force power interactions, destruction sequences, and set-piece moments in LucasFilm's proprietary engine while serving as a technical resource for mission scripting across the team.

EDUCATION

Master of Entertainment Technology | Carnegie Mellon University — Pittsburgh PA

Bachelor of Science, Electrical and Computer Engineering | Carnegie Mellon University — Pittsburgh PA